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Editor-in-Chief
The R Journal

Dear Editor,

Please consider our manuscript titled “Grouper: Optimal Assignment Workflows for Higher Education” for publication in *The R Journal*.

This manuscript presents **grouper**, an R package for higher-education allocation workflows based on mixed-integer optimization. The package supports three recurring planning tasks: assigning students to groups and topics while promoting diversity, assigning self-formed groups to topic slots based on stated preferences, and allocating multi-role workload under fairness, preference, and priority constraints. The paper emphasizes structured inputs, configurable objective functions, solver-backed model construction, and interpretable outputs that map back to teaching and administrative records.

We believe this submission is suitable for *The R Journal* because it centers on package design, implementation, and reproducible R workflows. The article is intended for R users in higher-education institutions, including instructors and administrators who need practical allocation tools but may not want to write mixed-integer models directly. It also shows how **grouper** builds on existing R optimization infrastructure, including **ompr**, **ompr.roi**, and ROI-backed solvers.

The submission includes the manuscript source, bibliography, generated PDF/TeX/R files, anonymized data for AY2420, AY2510, and AY2520, generated figures, a package list, reproducibility scripts, and the consolidated Shiny frontend source. The scripts regenerate the cross-semester results and figures, run the separate solver benchmark, and provide print-only checks for the manual objective and hyperparameter sensitivity.

Regards,
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